

OPERATIONAL STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)

Yelp Leads Management Guide

Daily workflow, conversation handling, quote delivery, and pipeline tracking inside GoHighLevel for Sales Reps, Dispatchers, and Virtual Assistants.

Standard: **Jacksonville Golden Master**

Delivery Channel: **Pure Email Relay (Zero SMS)**

First Response Target: **< 90 Seconds**

Updated: **October 2026**

SPEED TO LEAD

< 90s Response

Maintains "Replies in minutes" badge

DELIVERY CHANNEL

100% In-App Chat

Renders as native Yelp chat bubbles

COMPLIANCE

Zero SMS Blasts

100% safe from carrier 10DLC flags

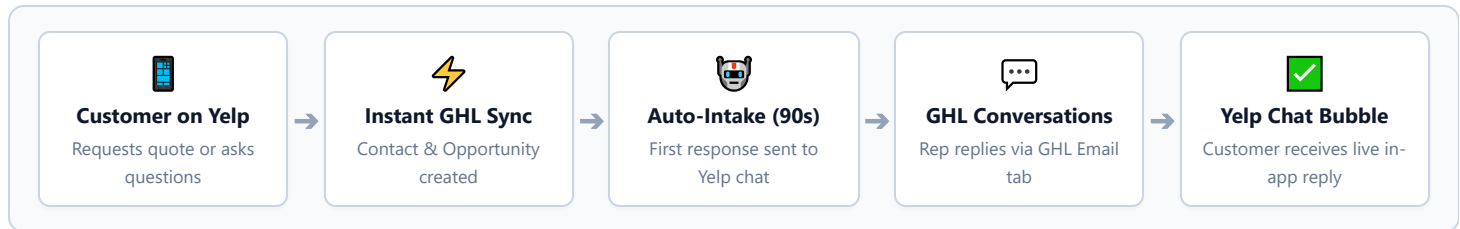
PIPELINE ARCHITECTURE

8 Clean Stages

Automated & manual status tracking

1 How the Yelp ↔ GoHighLevel System Works

When a homeowner asks for a quote or messages on Yelp, the entire lead profile is instantly synced into your GoHighLevel CRM. Messages sent by reps from GHL are converted into live chat bubbles in the customer's Yelp app.



2 The 3 Golden Rules (Strict Operations Policy)

Rule 1: Always Reply via EMAIL

The customer's email in GHL is mapped to Yelp's relay (leadsapi+...@messaging.yelp.com). **Always keep the composer on Email.** Yelp intercepts your email and posts it as a live chat bubble on the customer's phone screen. *Never switch to SMS for initial Yelp leads!*

Rule 2: Phone Number Protocol

If a customer provided a phone number, it is stored in their profile and tagged **yelp-phone-captured**. **Call them directly** if they ask for a call or if a large job needs rapid qualification. **Never** send unprompted marketing text blasts.

Rule 3: Keep biz.yelp.com Closed

If you leave **biz.yelp.com** or the Yelp for Business app open on your computer or phone, Yelp thinks you are chatting on their site and **suppresses real-time email notifications to GHL**. Conduct all chatting inside GHL.

Email Relay Mechanics (Subject vs. Body & Workflows vs. Conversations):

- **Subject Line:** Ignored and discarded by Yelp. The customer never sees it. (GHL only requires it to send).
- **Email Body:** Extracted by Yelp and rendered directly as the live chat bubble inside the consumer's Yelp app.
- **Workflow Emails vs. Conversations:** Workflows send automated 90s greetings & 24h nudges; the Conversations tab is where reps type manual 1-on-1 replies (custom pricing & booking). Both send via **Email** to reach Yelp chat.

3 Where to Find Yelp Leads in GoHighLevel

Area	What You See	How to Use It
Conversations → All	Chats tagged with <code>source: yelp</code> and <code>yelp-lead</code>	Click to open the conversation thread. Read inbound customer messages and reply using the Email tab.
Contact Details Panel	Folder: Yelp Lead Details	Contains parsed data: <i>Bedrooms, Bathrooms, Service Type, Frequency, Notes, and Captured Phone.</i>
Opportunities Pipeline	Pipeline [N] - Yelp Leads Pipeline	Kanban board showing deal progress across all 8 stages from New Lead to Closed Won.

4 Step-by-Step SOP: Handling a Lead from Inbound to Booked

Step 1: Lead Ingestion & Automated Intake (Minutes 0 – 2)

The lead automatically enters **Stage 1: New Leads**. The automation waits 90 seconds (giving Yelp's phone API time to attach a phone number) and sends a personalized initial greeting. **No action is required from you yet.**

Step 2: Customer Replies in Yelp Chat (Active Lead)

When the customer replies on Yelp, their message instantly appears in **GHL Conversations**. The system automatically cancels further automated no-answer nudges. **Your Action:** Drag the Opportunity card to **Stage 3: In Conversation / Qualified**.

Step 3: Calculating and Sending the Quote

Check the Yelp Lead Details folder (Bedrooms, Bathrooms, Notes). In GHL Conversations, ensure the **Email** tab is selected, and send your quote:

"Hi {{contact.first_name}}, thanks for reaching out! For a [X] bed / [Y] bath [Service Type], our estimate is \${Price} (approx. [Hours] labor hours). We have availability this [Day] morning or [Day] afternoon. Would either of those work best for your schedule?"

After clicking Send, drag the Opportunity card to **Stage 4: Quoted** and add tag **yelp-quote-sent**.

Step 4: Booking the Job & Collecting Payment

When the customer confirms: collect their full address, schedule the clean on the GHL Calendar, drag the card to **Stage 8: Closed Won**, and send a final Yelp confirmation message:

"You are all set for [Day, Date] at [Time]! Our team looks forward to serving you. If you need anything before your clean, reach out here or call us at [Office Phone]."

5 The 8 Pipeline Stages & Automated Movement

#	Stage Name	Meaning / Action	Automation Behavior
1	New Leads	Initial landing stage for every new Yelp quote request.	System fires 90s auto-response.
2	No Answer	Customer has not replied to initial greeting within 24h.	Moved automatically by workflow; sends Nudge #1.
3	Quoted	Formal estimate sent; awaiting customer booking decision.	Manual move by Rep; triggers 48h quote check-in.
4	Follow Up (Manual)	Special handling required (e.g. custom sq footage, phone call).	Manual move by Rep for personal follow-up.
5	Follow Up (Automated)	Customer has gone silent for 72h+ without replying.	Moved automatically by workflow; sends final check-in.
6	Interested but not booked	Customer engaged but waiting on spouse, date, or budget.	Manual move by Rep; paused from automated drips.
7	Not Qualified	Out of service radius, spam, or unsupported service type.	Manual move by Rep; disarms all workflows.
8	Closed Won	Customer confirmed, deposit collected, scheduled on calendar.	Manual move by Rep; tags yelp-booked .

6 Frequently Asked Questions & Troubleshooting

Question / Issue	Explanation & Solution
Do we send messages via email? Which part reaches the lead?	Yes. We compose using the Email tab in GHL. Yelp's relay server completely strips and discards the Subject line. Only the Email Body is extracted and displayed to the customer as an in-app chat bubble.
Is moving a card to "Follow Up (Automated)" supposed to trigger a workflow?	No. In the Jacksonville Standard, Follow Up (Automated) is an output destination that the workflow automatically moves contacts into after 72 hours of silence. It is not an input trigger.
Why was the response time slow previously, and how is it fixed?	Previously, leads were either delayed or misrouted. In our new setup, the automated intake sends an official response in under 90 seconds , which permanently restores the " <i>Typically replies in minutes</i> " badge on Yelp.
Customer message didn't appear in GHL?	Check if someone has <code>biz.yelp.com</code> or the Yelp for Business mobile app actively open. Close all Yelp Biz tabs so Yelp routes notifications via email to GHL.
Message failed to send from GHL?	Check the selected communication tab. If you accidentally clicked SMS , change it to Email and re-send.